ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 7

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 2 · LITERATURE

MARKS: 60 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Short story (25) · Section B: Poetry (20) · Section C: Drama (15). The texts are new to learners (unseen) and were written by Academic Central, so learners practise the literary skills used with any set work: character, setting, plot, conflict, theme, figures of speech, rhyme, tone and stage directions.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 7. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Short story (25 marks), SECTION B: Poetry (20 marks) and SECTION C: Drama (15 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Read each text carefully before you answer the questions on it.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where you are asked to explain.

SECTION A: SHORT STORY

QUESTION 1

Read the short story and answer the questions that follow.

Borrowed Boots

Ayanda pressed her thumb through the hole in the toe of her soccer boot and sighed. The sole was flapping like the mouth of a tired dog, and the final against Riverside Primary was only five days away.

"You can't play in those," said her best friend Naledi as they walked home along the dusty road. "Coach Mahlangu won't allow it."

"I know," Ayanda said quietly. She did not tell Naledi that new boots cost R450, and that her mother, who cleaned offices in town, had already said no. "Not this month, my child. The electricity comes first."

That evening Ayanda sat on the step outside their two-roomed house in Soweto, gluing the sole with a tube of glue she had found in the kitchen drawer. Her brother Musa came home late, smelling of soap and petrol from the car wash where he worked after school. He was seventeen and tall, and he always had a joke ready.

"What are you doing to those poor boots?" he teased.

"Saving them," she said, without looking up.

Musa watched her for a long time. Then he went inside without another word.

For the rest of the week Musa left home before sunrise and came back after dark. Twice Ayanda saw him eat only dry bread for supper, and on Thursday she noticed that his own takkies were held together with a piece of wire.

On Friday morning there was a shoebox on Ayanda's bed. Inside, wrapped in newspaper, was a pair of shiny black soccer boots with white stripes. A note in Musa's untidy handwriting said: *For the best striker in Soweto. Score one for me.*

Ayanda ran outside, but Musa had already left for work.

The final was played under a burning sun. Riverside scored first, and for most of the match Ayanda's team chased shadows. Then, with two minutes left, the ball rolled towards her. Her new boots felt light, as if they had wings. She took one touch, looked up and struck the ball with all her strength. It flew past the goalkeeper's fingertips and into the corner of the net.

The crowd exploded. In the noise, Ayanda searched the faces along the fence until she found one – Musa, still in his wet car-wash overall, waving both arms above his head.

After the match, when the medals had been handed out, she walked straight to the fence and hung hers around her brother's neck.

"This one is yours," she said.

Musa looked down at the medal, then at his sister, and for once he did not have a joke ready.

1.1	Who is the main character in this story?	(1)
1.2	Describe the setting of the story. Give TWO details about the place.	(2)
1.3	"The sole was flapping like the mouth of a tired dog." Name the figure of speech and explain what it tells us about the boot.	(2)
1.4	Why could Ayanda's mother not buy her new boots?	(1)
1.5	What do the words "The electricity comes first" tell us about the family's situation?	(2)
1.6	What is the main conflict (problem) in the story?	(2)
1.7	Give TWO pieces of evidence from the story which show that Musa gave up things for his sister.	(2)
1.8	Why do you think Musa "went inside without another word"?	(2)
1.9	What does Musa's note tell us about the way he feels about Ayanda?	(2)
1.10	Which event is the climax (the most exciting moment) of the story?	(1)
1.11	"Her new boots felt light, as if they had wings." What does this tell us about how Ayanda felt at that moment?	(2)
1.12	Why was Musa "still in his wet car-wash overall" at the match?	(1)
1.13	Why did Ayanda hang her medal around Musa's neck?	(2)
1.14	At the end Musa "did not have a joke ready". What does this tell us about his feelings?	(1)
1.15	What is the main theme (message) of this story?	(2)

[25]

SECTION B: POETRY

QUESTION 2

Read the two poems and answer the questions on BOTH poems.

POEM 1: Rain in the Township

The sky turns grey above the street,
The dusty road begins to sigh,
And children run on bare brown feet
To watch the clouds go tumbling by.

Then plip and plop on rooftops tin,
The thunder drums its heavy song,
The rain comes rushing, rushing in,
And washes all the heat along.

Tomorrow mud will paint our shoes,
And puddles will be lakes and seas,
But now we have no time to lose –
We dance with rain beneath the trees.

2.1 How many stanzas does Poem 1 have? (1)

2.2 Write down the rhyme scheme of stanza 1. (2)

2.3 "The dusty road begins to sigh" (line 2). Name the figure of speech and explain why the poet uses it. (2)

2.4 Quote an example of onomatopoeia from stanza 2. (1)

2.5 Why does the poet repeat the word "rushing" in line 7? (2)

2.6 "And puddles will be lakes and seas" (line 10). Are the puddles really lakes and seas? Explain what the poet means. (2)

2.7 Describe the mood of the children in the last stanza. Quote a line to support your answer. (2)

POEM 2: My Gogo's Hands

My gogo's hands
are maps of a long journey,
every line a road she walked.

They have planted maize in hard ground,
plaited my hair before school,
and stirred the pot of pap
until the kitchen smelled like home.

Her hands are slow now,
trembling like leaves in winter,
but when she holds my face
they are still the strongest hands
in the world.

2.8 Whom is the speaker describing in Poem 2? (1)

2.9 "My gogo's hands / are maps of a long journey" (lines 1–2). Name the figure of speech and explain what the speaker means. (3)

2.10 Name TWO things that Gogo's hands have done for the family. (2)

2.11 Quote the simile in stanza 3 and explain what it tells us about Gogo now. (2)

[20]

SECTION C: DRAMA

QUESTION 3

Read the drama scene and answer the questions that follow.

The Wallet

Characters: SIZWE (12) · KAMO (12) · MRS PILLAY, owner of the corner shop
Setting: The pavement outside Pillay's Corner Shop, late on a hot afternoon.

(SIZWE and KAMO walk on, kicking an empty tin. KAMO stops suddenly and picks up a brown leather wallet.)

KAMO: *(whispering)* Sizwe! Look at this!

SIZWE: *(opening it)* Eish! There's money inside … five hundred rand! And an ID card.

KAMO: *(grinning)* Five hundred! We can buy airtime, chips, cold drinks … for a whole month!

SIZWE: *(frowning)* But it isn't ours, Kamo.

KAMO: Finders keepers. Nobody saw us.

SIZWE: *(reading the ID card)* The name says Meena Pillay. *(He points at the shop.)* That's the shop lady!

KAMO: *(crossing his arms)* So? She's rich. She owns a whole shop.

SIZWE: My mother says you don't show who you are when people are watching. You show who you are when nobody is watching.

(Pause. KAMO kicks the tin hard. It clatters across the pavement.)

KAMO: *(sighing)* Fine. But if she doesn't say thank you, I'm never listening to your mother again.

(They enter the shop. MRS PILLAY is behind the counter, searching through her handbag. She looks worried.)

MRS PILLAY: *(anxiously)* Not now, boys, I've lost something very important …

SIZWE: *(holding out the wallet)* Is it this, Mrs Pillay?

MRS PILLAY: *(gasping, her hand on her heart)* My wallet! The money for my mother's medicine is in there! Where did you find it?

KAMO: *(proudly)* On the pavement. I saw it first.

(MRS PILLAY laughs. She takes two cold drinks from the fridge and puts them on the counter.)

MRS PILLAY: Honest boys deserve something cold on a hot day. And from now on, you two get your bread at half price.

(KAMO looks at SIZWE, who raises his eyebrows.)

KAMO: *(quietly)* Okay … maybe your mother is right.

(Lights fade.)

3.1	Where does the first part of the scene take place?	(1)
3.2	What are the words in brackets and italics called, and what is their purpose?	(2)
3.3	What does Kamo want to do with the money?	(1)
3.4	How does Sizwe find out who owns the wallet?	(1)
3.5	Explain in your own words what Sizwe's mother means when she says, "You show who you are when nobody is watching."	(2)
3.6	"KAMO kicks the tin hard." What does this action show about how Kamo feels?	(1)
3.7	What is the conflict between the two boys in this scene?	(2)
3.8	Why is the money especially important to Mrs Pillay?	(1)
3.9	Kamo says, "I saw it first." What does this tell us about him?	(1)
3.10	How has Kamo changed by the end of the scene? Refer to his last words.	(2)
3.11	In ONE word, give the main theme of this drama.	(1)
		[15]

TOTAL: 60

END OF QUESTION PAPER